

Daily Bible Note

Date: July 30, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 33:10-20

10 "Therefore you, O son of man, say to the house of Israel: 'Thus you say, "If our transgressions and our sins lie upon us, and we pine away in them, how can we then live?"'

11 Say to them: 'As I live,' says the Lord God, 'I have no pleasure in the death of the wicked, but that the wicked turn from his way and live. Turn, turn from your evil ways! For why should you die, O house of Israel?'

12 "Therefore you, O son of man, say to the children of your people: 'The righteousness of the righteous man shall not deliver him in the day of his transgression; as for the wickedness of the wicked, he shall not fall because of it in the day that he turns from his wickedness; nor shall the righteous be able to live because of his righteousness in the day that he sins.'

13 When I say to the righteous that he shall surely live, but he trusts in his own righteousness and commits iniquity, none of his righteous works shall be remembered; but because of the iniquity that he has committed, he shall die.

14 Again, when I say to the wicked, 'You shall surely die,' if he turns from his sin and does what is lawful and right,

15 if the wicked restores the pledge, gives back what he has stolen, and walks in the statutes of life without committing iniquity, he shall surely live; he shall not die.

16 None of his sins which he has committed shall be remembered against him; he has done what is lawful and right; he shall surely live.

17 "Yet the children of your people say, 'The way of the Lord is not fair.' But it is their way which is not fair!

18 When the righteous turns from his righteousness and commits iniquity, he shall die because of it.

19 But when the wicked turns from his wickedness and does what is lawful and right, he

shall live because of it.

20 Yet you say, 'The way of the Lord is not fair.' O house of Israel, I will judge every one of you according to his own ways."

II. Key Summary

- The people of Israel say their transgressions and sins lie upon them, they are wasting away in them, and they ask how they can then live (v. 10).
 - God swears by His own life that He has no pleasure in the death of the wicked, only that the wicked turn from his way and live, and He calls out, "Turn, turn from your evil ways!" (v. 11).
 - God says a righteous man's righteousness will not deliver him on the day he sins, while a wicked man who turns from sin — restoring the pledge and giving back what he stole — shall surely live; twice the people say, "The way of the Lord is not fair," and God answers that He will judge each one according to his own ways (vv. 12-20).
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III. Passage Analysis

God Really Doesn't Want to Watch Anyone Go Down That Road

God takes no special pleasure in the death of the wicked. God's heart is for people to repent, to turn from their way and live. [1]

Israel already felt like they were finished. God's reply wasn't "you had it coming" — it was "turn back." What He cares about most in this whole passage is whether people get to live.

Turning Back Is More Than Feeling Bad for a While

True repentance is more than grieving over sin; it includes turning away from sin completely. It also means working at doing what is right and giving back what was gained unjustly. ... The repentance God accepts is a life that actually changes in everyday living. [2]

The examples in the passage are concrete — return the pledge, give back what you stole. Real turning back is something you can see in a person's daily life.

IV. Reflection Question

Do you believe a person can really change — including you?

In this passage God says He has no pleasure in the death of the wicked; what He wants is for people to turn from their way and live.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Commentary on Ezekiel 33,
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-33/>

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Website (ccbiblestudy.org), Precious Bible Study Guide (聖經精讀本), Notes on Ezekiel 33 (translated from Traditional Chinese),
<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT33.htm>